

points were also awarded to printers that excelled in characteristics like build quality, thoroughness of documentation, bundled software etc.

Build quality

When buying a printer, you should examine the build quality, especially of the movable components such as the paper tray. Since you would be handling the paper feed tray very often, it will wear out fast if it is flimsy in its build. Also look for any breakable flaps and examine the rollers in the paper path and the print assembly as shoddy build in this area can cause paper jams.

The Epson EPL 5700 L and the Epson 5800 were strongly built but their lacklustre performance was the biggest disappointment. The Samsung ML 6060 N and the Lexmark Optra M412 had the best overall build quality.

The Lexmark Optra E312L and the Wipro Laser 1500 were also pretty strongly built. The Minolta had a very fragile cover that could break if not handled carefully. The HP LaserJet 1220 SE and LaserJet 1200 were good in performance but proved quite fragile.

CONCLUSION

If you need to print only occasionally, an inexpensive and basic inkjet printer would suffice. But if you need the best in terms of speed and performance, you'll definitely need to go in for a laser printer, especially if you need to print a large volume of text documents. A laser printer will print sharper and cleaner text than an inkjet printer—even if it has a lower print resolution than the inkjet. The printer that outshone the others was the **Lexmark Optra M412**.

LEXMARK Optra M412:
Great speeds with quality



Minolta QMS Page
Pro 1100:
Low-cost option



This was not only the fastest printer at 16.61 prints per minute, but it also had the crispness and quality in the prints. But if you consider the price tag, this printer would be more ideal for a workgroup with five or more users connected in a network.

For a home user, the best bet would be the **Minolta QMS PagePro 1100**. The printer is much more affordable, with ample speed and quality. With the facility that incorporates a scanner-cum-copier, the Hewlett-Packard LaserJet 1220Se would be a wise choice for a user who seeks a complete office solution. 

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